

Static vs Interactive

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Static

Static insights for dashboards can be used to clearly illustrate or define metrics and what needs to be explained accordingly. Static visuals should be used more often towards an audience that is making decisions according to the analysis that the insight showcases. This would be managers/executives who do not need the added information anything interactive would need. This is basically boils down to be a report using live data. That doesn't mean they should not have access to anything interactive but to primarily use static visuals to report on the status or insights from the dashboard.

These are also really good to show KPI trackers and other useful quick glance information, to answer the question "Are we doing ok?" Yes/no.

Interactive

This would primarily be for analysts and the consumers of the data products to play around with. This should be as close to a sandbox without giving direct access to the source data it is pulling from. They should have enough 'freedom' to explore and dive into a given topic that is being showcased. Being able to interact and filter time periods or categories would enable the user to identify questions that need to be answered. But the drawback is the freedom of choice can lead to ambiguity in the messages trying to be portrayed on the dashboard and may even make everything even more confusing. Being mindful of what is being shown and limiting actions can mitigate this ambiguity and keep the main insights as the main focus

This is really good to show the why and how questions about the data being shown and a little bit of a deeper dive into the data where an executive summary would have too little detail to make any actions apparent.